

High-Protein Air-Fryer Burgers

This simple air-fryer burger recipe is a splatter-free method to cook up juicy burgers without a lot of fuss. The toppings are classic, but you can always adjust them to suit your taste.

By **Breana Lai Killeen, M.P.H., RD** | Updated on January 19, 2026

 Reviewed by Dietitian **Emily Lachtrupp, M.S., RD**

Active Time: 15 mins

Total Time: 35 mins

Servings: 4

Nutrition Profile:

Nut-Free Healthy Pregnancy Soy-Free High-Protein Egg-Free

Ingredients

- 1 pound 90%-lean ground beef
- 2 tablespoons Worcestershire sauce
- ¼ teaspoon salt
- ¼ teaspoon ground pepper
- 4 slices Cheddar cheese
- 4 whole-wheat hamburger buns, toasted
- 4 leaves butter lettuce
- 4 slices tomato
- 4 slices white onion
- ¼ cup dill pickle chips

Directions

Step 1

Preheat air fryer to 375°F for 5 minutes. Combine beef, Worcestershire, salt and pepper in a medium bowl. Form the mixture into 4 (4-ounce) patties, about 1/2-inch thick.

Step 2

Working in batches if necessary, arrange the patties in a single layer in the air-fryer basket. Cook, flipping once, until an instant-read thermometer inserted in the center registers 160°F, about 7 minutes. Top each patty with a cheese slice and cook until melted, about 30 seconds.

Step 3

Assemble the burgers on toasted buns with lettuce, tomato, onion and pickles.

Frequently Asked Questions

Can I use a different type of ground beef?

We use 90%-lean ground beef, which means it has about 10% fat and 90% lean meat. It's best to stick with this type: We chose this percentage of fat so that you don't end up with a dry burger—it's just enough fat to keep the burger juicy, but not so much that you end up with a greasy, dripping mess.

Can I use ground turkey instead of ground beef?

Yes, but be prepared to possibly have a drier burger, since ground turkey tends to be about 93% lean and 7% fat. If you're looking for a specific burger recipe using ground turkey, try our Turkey Burgers with Spinach, Feta & Tzatziki. This recipe uses frozen spinach in the burger to help prevent it from drying out too much.

Is there a low-carb option for the bun?

If you're looking for a fun, tasty, low-carb option to replace a traditional burger bun, try using two portobello mushrooms as buns or use a bell pepper, seeded and cut in half, to sandwich your burger between.

What other toppings can I add?

Feel free to add your favorite toppings, such as sliced avocado, sautéed mushrooms, caramelized onions, pimiento cheese or pickled red onions. Top your burger with sauces like Vidalia Onion BBQ Sauce, Avocado Goddess Sauce or Chipotle Ranch Dressing. Please note that any additional toppings will alter the nutritional profile of the recipe.

What do you serve with High-Protein Air-Fryer Burgers?

Serve with homemade french fries, sweet potato fries, mushroom fries, parsnip fries or zucchini fries and potato salad, pasta salad or broccoli salad to round out the meal.

How long does it take to cook burgers in the air fryer?

You'll know the burgers are done when an instant-read thermometer inserted in the center of the burgers registers 160°F. It should take about 7 minutes or so, flipping once.

Do you have to flip burgers in an air fryer?



Yes, we recommend flipping the burgers in the air fryer to ensure they cook and brown evenly.

Additional reporting by Carrie Myers and Jan Valdez

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Nutrition Facts

Per serving: **Serving Size 1 burger** 440 calories; total fat 20g; saturated fat 10g; cholesterol 100mg; sodium 730mg; total carbohydrate 27g; dietary fiber 4g; total sugars 5g; added sugars 2g; protein 29g; vitamin c 6mg; calcium 333mg; iron 5mg; potassium 433mg

Explore more:

Ingredient

Meat & Poultry

Beef

Ground Beef

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